

TAXPAYER LIABILITY FROM PLATE MISREADS · SCRIPT A

Misreads become million-dollar taxpayer problems

About 2.6 min at ~140 words/min · 360 words · Replace [Your Name]. Speak calmly. One speaker, one focus.

Tip: swap bracketed fields. Cite numbers carefully. End with the cancel / yearly-vote ask.

Mayor Crawford, members of City Council. My name is [Your Name], and I live in Crossville.

Please think about liability before you renew.

Automated plate readers misread plates. When officers treat a bad read as certain, families get guns drawn on them, get handcuffed, and get traumatized, and cities write settlement checks paid for by the taxpayers and voters. Aurora, Colorado paid about 1.9 million dollars in the Gilliam case after an ALPR-related wrongful stop. San Francisco, CA, paid about 495,000 dollars in the Denise Green case. Those were not Flock-branded products. They show what ALPR errors cost taxpayers.

Business Insider reported that Roseville, California police found Flock misread plates in about seventy-one percent of stolen or felony vehicle alerts in 2023 and 2024. Roseville said those incorrect alerts did not produce stops because officers verify first. Closer to home, Business Insider's police-records reporting describes a Morristown stop tied to a Flock alert after the system misread the letter O in a personalized plate reading LOVEY as a zero, and matched it to a stolen plate. Tennessee hasn't had to endure a multimillion-dollar settlement yet. Not getting struck by lightning yet does not mean I should play a round of golf in the middle of a storm. Tennessee's retention law in the Tennessee Code Annotated only limits how long plate data may be stored. It does not block federal civil-rights lawsuits.

Crossville should not wait to be the next defendant. One bad stop can cost more than years of the camera budget. Other cities' settlements show what Crossville could pay. Roseville shows how often Flock alerts can be wrong. Morristown is the warning when verification fails. Crossville should not wait to learn the same lesson until the settlement checks are being signed.

THE ASK (say this)

My ask is clear. Cancel Crossville's Flock contract and remove the cameras. Require a public hearing and a recorded City Council vote before any surveillance equipment is ever proposed again. If you will not cancel yet, take a recorded yes-or-no vote each year before any renewal, with no automatic renewal that skips a public vote, and publish monthly use reports the public can check. Thank you. I yield.

7

Brittney Gilliam; 6yo daughter Lovely; 17yo sister; 14yo niece; 12yo niece - Aurora

VICTIM NAME

Brittney Gilliam; 6yo daughter Lovely; 17yo sister; 14yo niece; 12yo niece

INCIDENT DATE

2020-08-02

INCIDENT YEAR

2020

CITY

Aurora

COUNTY

Arapahoe

STATE

CO

POLICE DEPARTMENT

Aurora Police Department

TECHNOLOGY

ALPR

ALERT REASON

Stolen vehicle

NARRATIVE SUMMARY

Aurora PD ALPR/system flagged Gilliam's Colorado-plated SUV as matching a stolen Montana motorcycle with same plate number but different state. High-risk stop in parking lot: family including children forced prone at gunpoint; Gilliam, sister, and 12yo handcuffed; 6yo and 14yo ordered hands up face-down on hot pavement. Mistake discovered after handcuffing. \$1.9M settlement Feb 2024.

CURRENT CASE STATUS

Settled

CONFIDENCE SCORE

0.97

VICTIM SEX

F

VICTIM RACE

Black

TECHNOLOGY CATEGORY

ALPR

VENDOR

ALPR (not Flock Safety)

2

Denise Green - San Francisco

VICTIM NAME

Denise Green

INCIDENT DATE

2009-03-30

INCIDENT YEAR

2009

CITY

San Francisco

COUNTY

San Francisco

STATE

CA

POLICE DEPARTMENT

San Francisco Police Department

TECHNOLOGY

ALPR (mobile/car-mounted)

ALERT REASON

Stolen vehicle

NARRATIVE SUMMARY

SFPD ALPR misread Green's plate (3 as 7), alerting that her burgundy Lexus was a stolen gray GMC truck. Without visually confirming the full plate, officers conducted a high-risk stop: guns drawn (including shotgun per Green), forced to knees, handcuffed, person and vehicle searched; released after ~20 minutes when manual plate check showed mismatch.

CURRENT CASE STATUS

Settled

CONFIDENCE SCORE

0.98

VICTIM AGE

47

VICTIM SEX

F

VICTIM RACE

Black

OFFICER NAMES

Sgt. Ja Han Kim; Officers Alberto Esparza; Robert Pedersen